

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Source: survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Global Employment Status (65,437 respondents)

Full-time: 69%

Independent contracting / freelancing: 16.4%

Full-time students: 13.2%

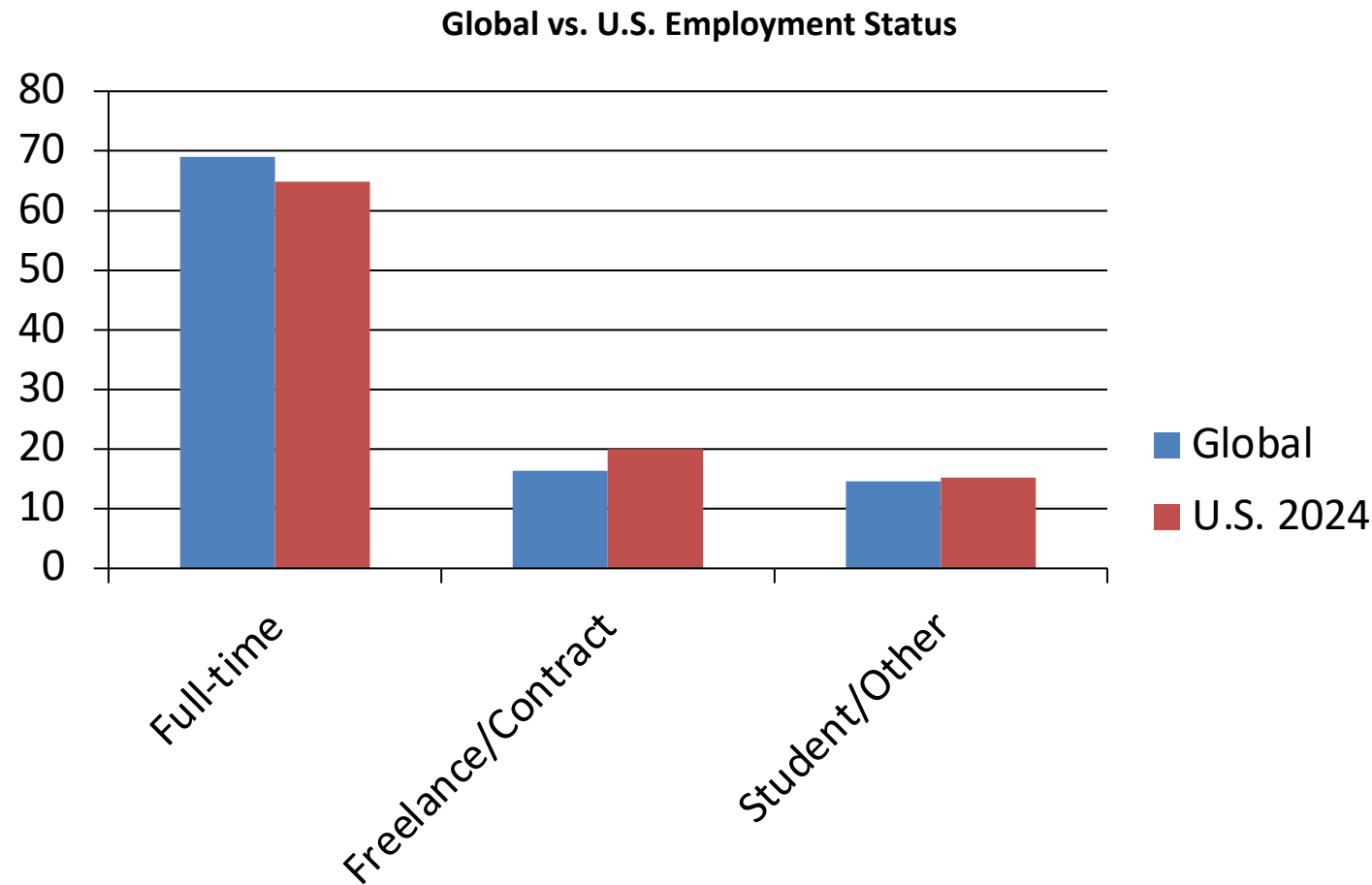
84% total are currently working (full-time, part-time, or freelancing)

U.S. Full-Time Employment Shift

2023: 69% full-time

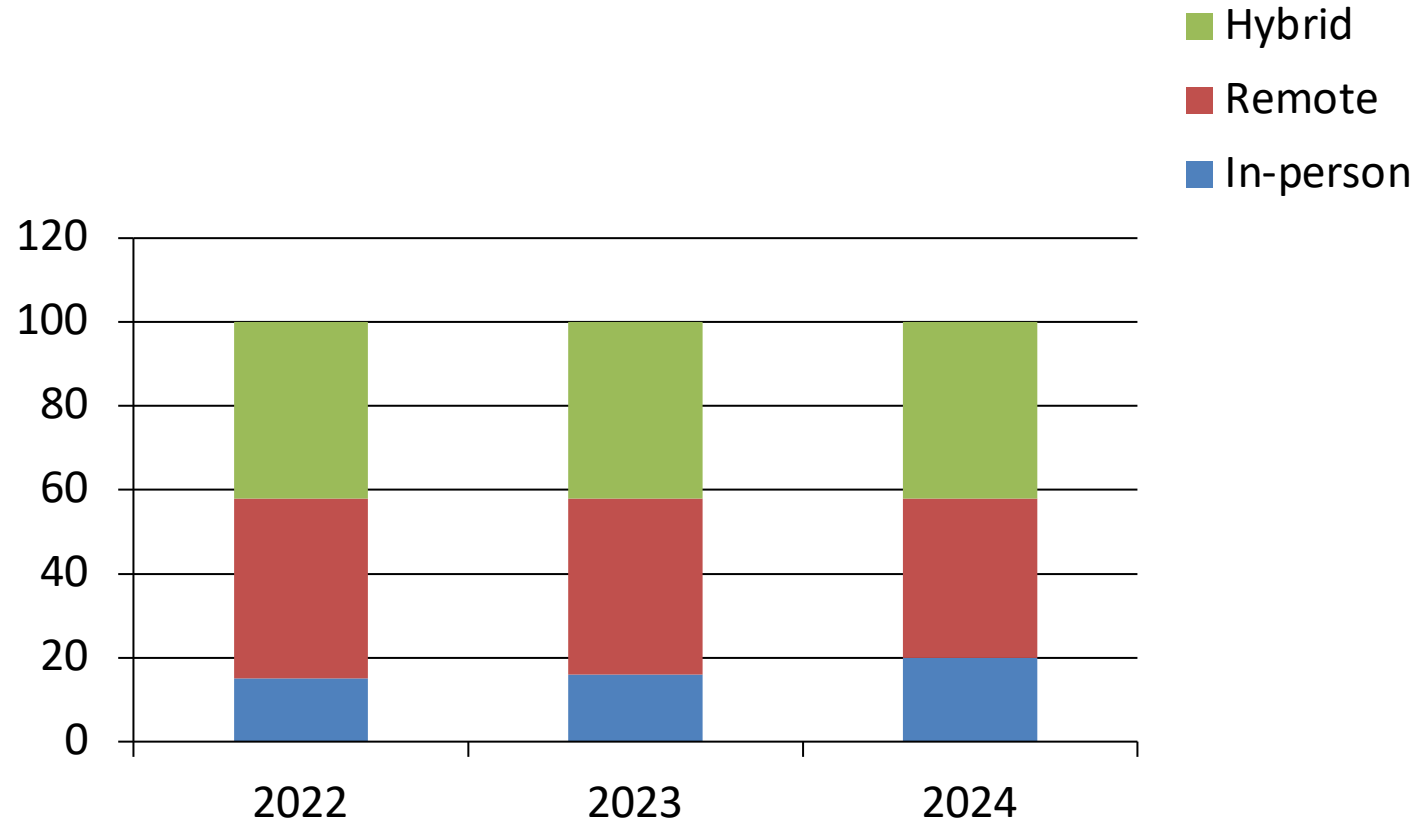
2024: 64.8% full-time

↓ 4.2 percentage point drop year-over-year



In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

Work Environment Trends (2022–2024)



Key Insights

Hybrid remains the dominant arrangement at 42%, unchanged from 2023.

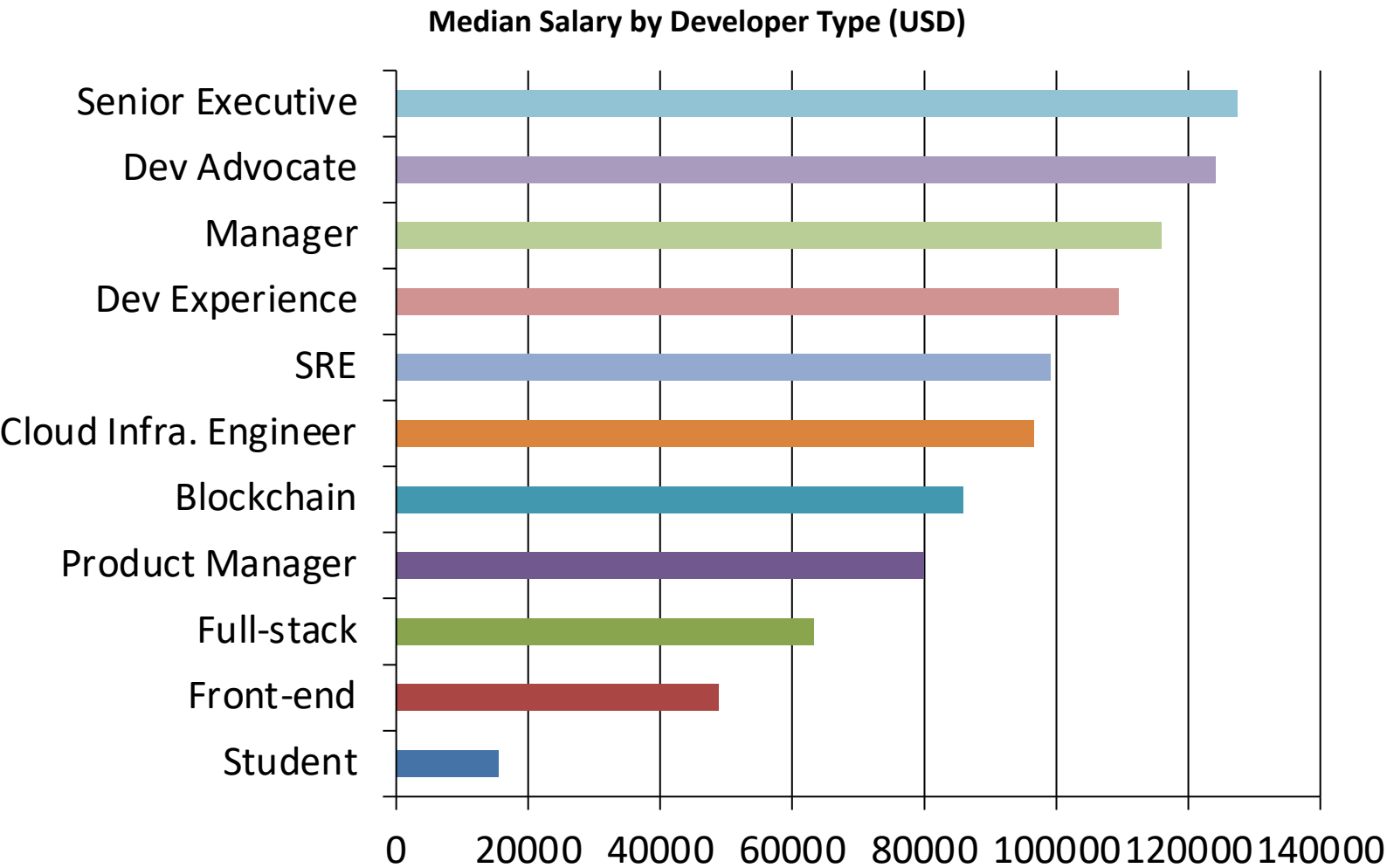
Remote work declined from 43% (2022) to 38% (2024).

In-person work has risen for three consecutive years:

- 2022: 15%
- 2023: 16%
- 2024: 20%

Signal: gradual return-to-office trend, though hybrid still dominates.

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary



Top Earners

- Senior Executive: \$127,388 (~17 yrs)
- Dev Advocate: \$124,203 (~16 yrs)
- Manager: \$115,999 (~15 yrs)
- Dev Experience: \$109,483 (~12 yrs)
- SRE: \$99,099 (~10 yrs)
- Cloud Infra: \$96,666 (~13 yrs)

Note: SREs and Cloud Infra Engineers are the highest-paid purely technical roles.

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



Patterns

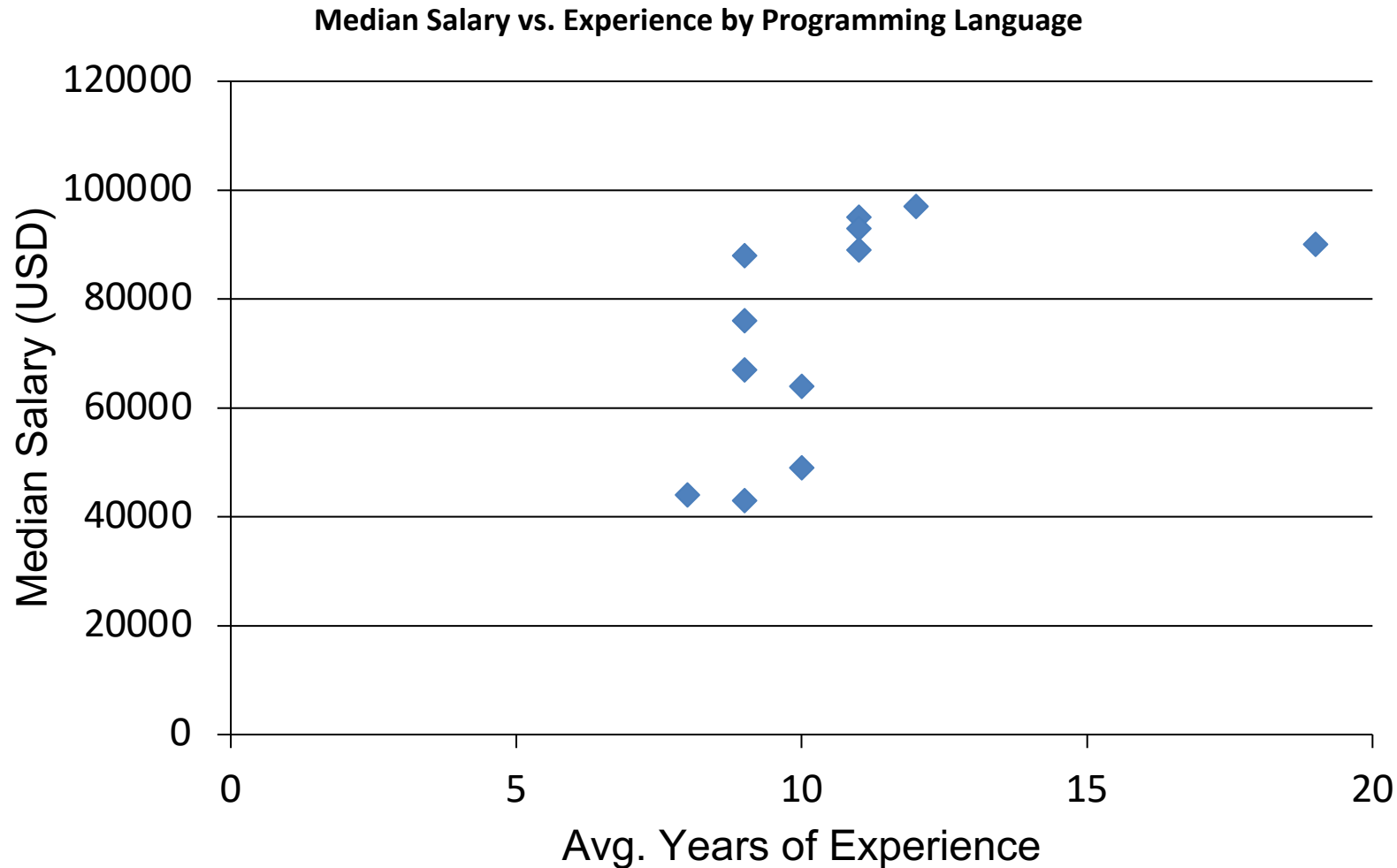
Senior roles cluster in the upper-right: 14+ years experience and \$100K+ salaries.

Student is a clear outlier at ~2 years / \$15K.

SRE and Cloud Infra break the trend — high pay at ~10–13 years experience.

Front-end developers show lower pay relative to experience (~8 yrs / \$49K).

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K



Language Insights

Niche functional languages earn the most:
Erlang (~\$97K), Clojure (~\$95K), Elixir (~\$93K).

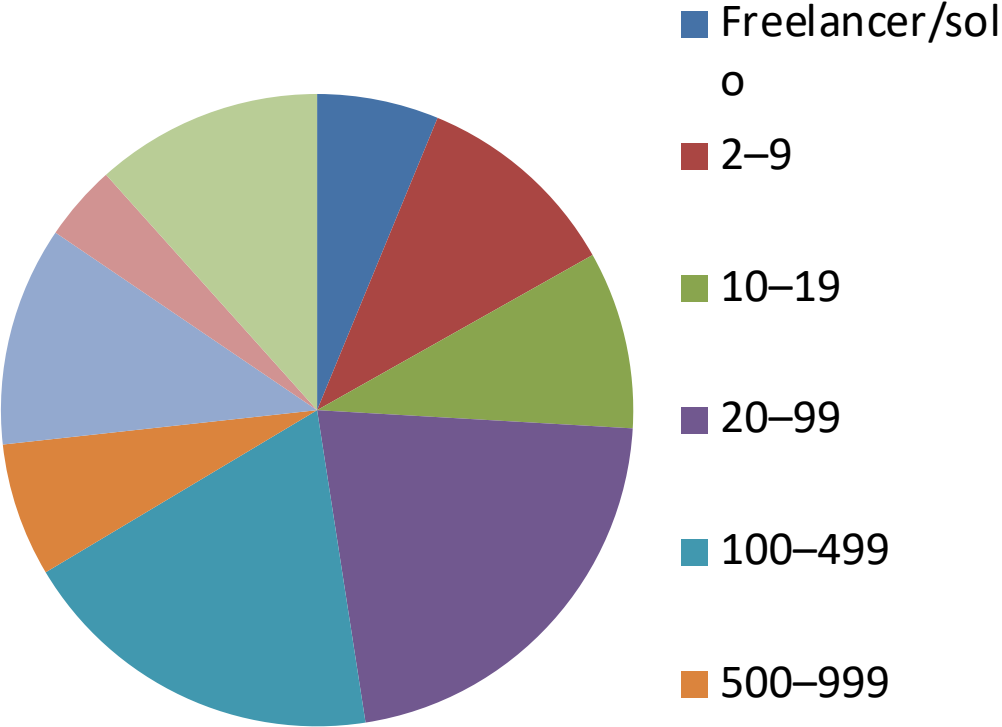
Mainstream languages sit in the mid-range: Go (~\$76K), Python (~\$67K), JavaScript (~\$64K).

Lowest earners: Dart (~\$44K), Prolog (~\$43K), PHP (~\$49K).

Overall salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023:
now \$60–75K average vs. \$70–85K last year.

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company Size Distribution (n=42,827)



Technology Purchasing Influence

62% of respondents influence technology purchases at their organization.

Most influential roles:

- Senior Executives: 99%
- Engineering Managers: 87%
- Product Managers: 77%

60% prefer a build-and-buy approach over purely building or buying.

Top evaluation methods:

- Start a free trial: 75%
- Ask other developers: 73%

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

1. Full-time employment is softening

Plan for more contractors and freelancers in your workforce mix. U.S. full-time employment fell 4 percentage points YoY; freelancing remains significant at 16%+ globally.

2. In-person mandates are growing, but hybrid still dominates

Return-to-office is gradual (20% in-person, up from 15% in 2022). Hybrid at 42% remains the most common arrangement — flexibility is still a key retention lever.

3. DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay

Senior Executives (\$127K), Dev Advocates (\$124K), and Managers (\$116K) top the chart. SREs and Cloud Infra Engineers are the highest-paid purely technical roles — budget accordingly.

4. Language choice correlates with pay — niche languages pay more

Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir developers earn >\$93K median, while mainstream languages like JavaScript and PHP sit well below \$65K. Overall averages dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023.

5. Most developers influence purchasing — engage them directly

62% have a say in tech buying decisions; 75% start with free trials. Vendor strategies should target individual contributors, not just management.